

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

SISTER JEAN DOLORES SCHMIDT 1919-2025

OUR BIG SISTER

By Shannon Ryan
Chicago Tribune

Beloved nun inspired Loyola's
deep NCAA Tournament runs

Sister Jean Dolores Schmidt, a nun who became a national sports icon for cheering on the Loyola men's basketball teams during their NCAA Tournament runs, died Thursday, the university said. She was 106.

Sister Jean, as seemingly everyone on the Rogers Park campus and later the sports world knew her, had served as the team chaplain since 1994 until her retirement this summer. For decades she was a fixture at Ramblers games, offering pregame prayers with players and fans.

She became nationally adored as



Loyola made a seemingly miraculous Final Four run in 2018. Her wheelchair was pushed onto the court after each victory, and Loyola players greeted her with gentle hugs as they exited the floor.

"She just lived an amazing life," Ramblers coach Drew Valentine said Friday at the Gentile Center that she called home. "Getting to know Sister Jean over the course of those years, I know in this situation she'd want to be honored and celebrated versus everyone being somber."

Valentine — an assistant coach for the Final Four team before being

Turn to Sister, Page 4

Sister Jean has a hearty laugh in her office on the campus of Loyola University in the Rogers Park neighborhood of Chicago in 2023. She became nationally adored as Loyola made a seemingly miraculous Final Four run in 2018. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Many return to ruins in Gaza

UN delivers critical supplies to territory as ceasefire begins

By Abdel Kareem Hana,
Wafaa Shurafa
and Melanie Lidman
Associated Press

WADI GAZA, Gaza Strip — Tens of thousands of Palestinians headed back to the heavily destroyed northern Gaza Strip on Friday as a U.S.-brokered ceasefire came into effect in a deal that raised hopes for ending the Israel-Hamas war. All the remaining hostages were set to be released within days.

Questions remain over who will govern Gaza as Israeli troops gradually pull back and whether Hamas will disarm, as called for in U.S. President Donald Trump's ceasefire plan. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, who unilaterally ended a ceasefire in March, hinted that Israel might renew its offensive if Hamas does not give up its weapons.

The latest truce marks a key step toward ending a ruinous two-year war that was triggered by Hamas' 2023 attack on Israel. The fighting has killed tens of thousands of Palestinians and displaced around 90% of the Gaza population of some 2 million, often multiple times. Many of them will find fields of rubble where their homes once stood.

The military confirmed the start of the ceasefire Friday, and the remaining 48 hostages, around 20 of them believed to be alive, are to be released by Monday. Palestinians said heavy shelling in parts of Gaza earlier Friday had mostly

Turn to Gaza, Page 6

NO NOBEL: President Donald Trump was passed over for the Nobel Peace Prize on Friday despite jockeying from fellow Republicans and — most vocally — himself. **Nation & World**

INSIDE

Cubs find way to flip the script

C After the Cubs lost the first two games of the NL Division Series in Milwaukee, and looked awful doing so, Chicago has fought back to put the pressure squarely on the Brewers, a team facing another postseason collapse. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**

MARATHON GUIDE: What to know if you plan to participate, cheer on a runner — or just want to avoid traffic jams on race day. **Chicagoland, Page 4**



Musicians play and sing in the protest area a block from the ICE holding facility in Broadview on Friday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Activists don't bend

Protesters return to Broadview as Duckworth, Durbin are again denied entry into ICE facility

By Rebecca Johnson,
Tess Kenny and
Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

Protesters and politicians gathered outside a federal building in Broadview on Friday to denounce the Trump administration's immigration enforcement mission a day after a judge temporarily blocked the president from using the National Guard in the effort.

Friday protests have become a weekly event at the Immigration and Customs Enforcement deten-

tion center, where federal agents have deployed tear gas and fired baton rounds at demonstrators on multiple occasions. The confrontations prompted local authorities to create a so-called Free Speech Zone, a dedicated area for people to voice opposition to the mass deportation mission.

There was no visible presence of the Texas National Guard at the facility Friday. The troops were occasionally spotted there Thursday before the judge's ruling,

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Illinois State Police troopers and Cook County sheriff's deputies push protesters in Broadview on Friday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE**

JOURNALIST DETAINED: ICE takes WGN producer into custody amid activity on the North Side on Friday. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

FENCE RULING: Judge tells ICE to remove controversial fencing around Broadview detainment center. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

MORE BUILDINGS: The Department of Homeland Security seeks more property for its actions in Chicagoland. **Business**



Metra unveils fare hikes for 2026

By Talia Soglin
Chicago Tribune

Metra riders should expect to pay an average of 13% more per ride next year as the commuter rail service proposes fare increases in response to a looming fiscal crisis.

The fare increases are outlined in Metra's proposed 2026 budget, which agency board members voted to release Friday. The budget

is subject to be approved by the agency's board next month.

Metra, the CTA and suburban bus service Pace are facing a structural budget deficit as they get closer to running out of one-time federal pandemic relief funds. Ridership, meanwhile, hasn't rebounded to pre-pandemic levels.

But despite the impending fiscal cliff, Metra has said it won't need to cut train service next year — even

if state lawmakers fail to approve additional transit funding during their legislative veto session this month.

That would change in 2027, Metra CEO Jim Derwinski said last week. Metra would then need to cut up to 40% of its service if lawmakers don't green-light more funding, he said.

Turn to Metra, Page 2

People sit aboard a Metra train at the Ogilvie Transportation Center in Chicago on Tuesday. Metra is proposing a \$1.1 billion operating budget for next year as a fiscal cliff looms. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

